

MAKE YOUR OWN YIDDISH-KITE



Dear Friend.

Here is all you need to know about how to make kites with your kids.

Enclosed in this file are:

1. Yiddish-Kite Instructions;
– includes instructions on the supplies, preparing for and making the Yiddish-Kite.

2. Yiddish-Kites;

Page 1 is the Kite shape *with* all the instructions included on it.

Page 2 is the Kite shape alone.

All you need to do to know and do to make it a successful program is here. If you follow the guidelines you have a money back guarantee for success. If you try to outsmart it – no promises... I've done this about 10 years in a row and it's pretty fine-tuned now.

The kids trace and cut out their own kite shape, attach tape and string to it and decorate it. Then they fly it. The whole project is theirs. It gets very exciting when the thing finally flies!

In order for the kids to make the kite shape, there should be enough original kite shapes from which they can trace. Every child should have his/her own original shape.

The shape is in this PDF file. The size of the paper is 20"x27". Unless you have a printer that can print it that size... - Email the pdf file to Kinkos for them to print.

Laminate the two pages and you will have them forever.

For all the copies you need – you can either print more copies of the kite shape, or – as I do – use the one original to make more copies, by tracing the shape onto a large roll of paper. Over and over again. Until you have enough copies for the group. You can laminate them or just roll 'em up and put 'em away for next time.

The kids will trace the shape from your copies onto their plastic.

They will then tape the wooden dowels and attach the string and decorate, as the instructions detail.

Kite Size is:

25" wide – from tip to tip of corner flaps.

17" high – from top tip to bottom tip

12" wide – neck of kite

11" wide – bottom base of kite

Supplies:

1. **Original Kite shape.** Print the Kite shapes in this file.
2. **Plastic for kite.** I suggest using very light (not heavy) CLEAR plastic, so that the decoration/name etc. will be the only thing visible in the sky.
Otherwise – any color will do.
You can use any kind of soft light plastic – garbage bags work fine. I usually find clear plastic bags that are smaller than the kite size – and cut the sides and bottom of the bag to enlarge it. Sometimes you may get lucky and find a roll of very light clear plastic
3. **Permanent Markers.** For drawing kite shape & decorating kite. Have enough for all the kids to draw at once, and include bright colors!
4. **Scissors.** To cut kite shape. Have one per child.
5. **Tape.** 8 pcs. of tape per kite. About 1" wide & 2½" – 3" long.
Clear Duct tape is my favorite. You may use another kind of tape – but make sure it sticks very well to the plastic and also comes off when needed – to fine-tune it.
6. **Wooden dowels.** 2 wooden dowels – 1/8th of an inch thick x 17" high.
These are sold in Home Depot / Lowes and any craft store.
7. **Hole puncher.** As many as you can spare.
8. **Kite string.** 1 roll of kite string per child. You can buy kite string on a roll in a utility / sports good / dollar store. They sell kite string for under .50 each roll of 200 or more feet.

Recap of supplies:

1. Original Kite shape
2. Plastic for kite
3. Permanent Markers
4. Scissors
5. Tape
6. Wooden dowels
7. Hole puncher
8. Roll of Kite string

Preparation:

Make a kite first. This way you will be able to answer all the kids' questions and **SHOW** them the final product.

Plan 45-60 minutes to make the kite including decoration. You can give more time for decoration. In a hurry, with a small cooperative group, it can be made in less than a ½ hour.

Prepare the pieces of tape *before* the kids come in. This is a *must* - not optional! Each child needs 8 pieces of tape! If you have 10 kids that is 80 pieces of tape. It takes time and patience to tear the tape. Stick the tape to the chairs tables and doorposts of the room.

Tip: It is easier to tear Duct Tape by hand, than it is to cut it by scissors. If you don't know how to tear it easily – ask someone to show you. You will tear *half the width* of the roll and keep going down the roll – as many pieces as you need and then a lot extra – just in case...

Cut the wooden dowels to size. Each kite needs two sticks - 17" high.

The dowels come in different sizes and you can usually use one stick per kite, and cut it to size.

My favorite wood cutter is the Easy Cutter from Midwest Products, sold in craft stores or possibly Home Depo etc. If all else fails – you can use a scissors!

Cut the strings that will be tied to the kite. About 3 feet per kite.

Some rolls of kite string are not tied to the base and will fly off as the string goes out. Tell the children to beware of that.

You need a very **Wide Empty Area** to fly the kites.

It will go up with very little wind – but there must be **SOME** wind!

So **Pray** hard, it usually works.

Prep the Kids:

The kids **WILL** get their kites tangled with each other's. Expect it.

The rule is: about *half* the kids will return *with* their kites...

Some will *fall* into the ocean. Some will get *stuck* in a high tree.

Some will *break* from the force of the wind and some will *fly* off to Hashem.

Prepare the kids about all this. Tell them that they just **MAY** come home with the kite = but most probably not! If you don't tell them – they will be very upset – it's not worth it! This way they will at least be prepped for the worst.

MAKE YOUR VERY OWN SURE-HIGH-FLY YIDDISH-KITE!

INSTRUCTIONS: FOLLOW THESE 10 SIMPLE STEPS IN THEIR NUMBER ORDER.

1 LAY your (clear) plastic down over the shape of the kite.

DRAW the kite shape onto the plastic

2 CUT out your kite along the outer **SOLID** lines. Do not cut the dotted lines.

(Have someone hold the plastic for you while you cut.)

MEASURE to make sure you cut evenly:

FOLD the kite in **HALF**, all ends should match - top, side & bottom. If they don't, make them (or the kite won't fly)!

CUT the extras of whichever side you need to, to match the sides to each other.

3 PLACE the 2 **WOODEN DOWELS** (sticks) down along the dotted lines.

The ends of the wooden dowels should reach both ends of the kite, the tippy tip and the corner on the bottom. If your stick is too short, then make sure it begins at the **TOP** of the kite, do **NOT** center the stick on the kite.

4 TAPE the wooden dowels to the kite.

Tape the **TOP** with 2-3" of tape, wrapping the tape vertically (straight up) over **BOTH SIDES** of the plastic, and covering the dowel **TIPS**.

TAPE the dowel to center & bottom of the kite with two small pieces of tape about 2" horizontally (going across to the sides).

5 TAPE about 2" of tape onto the tippy tips of both far corners (side flaps) of the kite. This is to strengthen the flaps, so they won't tear when the string pulls on them. Tip: Place the tape on the ground with the sticky side up. Place the corner of the kite over half the tape and fold the tape over the corner.

6 PUNCH a hole in the tape, 1/2 an inch from each corner. (Use a hole-puncher.)

7 TIE about 3 feet of string to the holes at both ends.

The **SAME** piece of string is tied to both sides - not 2 separate strings.

The string must be a few inches longer than the width of the kite on both sides.

8 MAKE A LOOP (knot) exactly in the middle of the string you tied.

Tip: Put the corner flaps of the kite together and pull both sides of the string up together to get the exact middle. Make your loop there. Make **SURE** the corners of the flaps are exactly even, when you hold the kite by the tip of the loop. This will ensure that the kite will fly.

9 DECORATE the kite.

DRAW your Hebrew name **BIG**, and any other Jewish decoration or message for the world - or Hashem, on the inside of the kite, so that when you fly it, your message will face us here on earth.

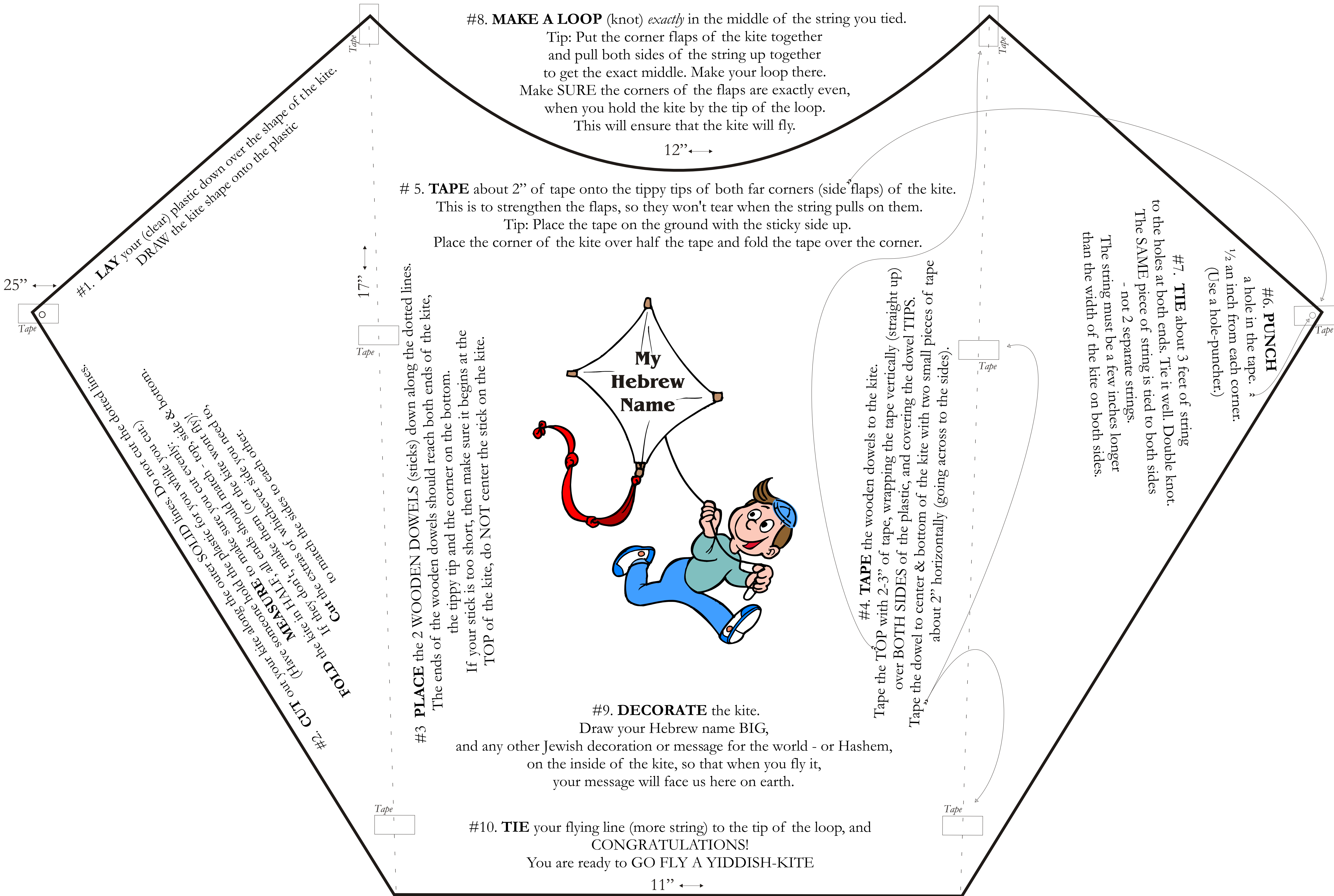
10 TIE your flying line (more string) to the tip of the loop, and **CONGRATULATIONS!**

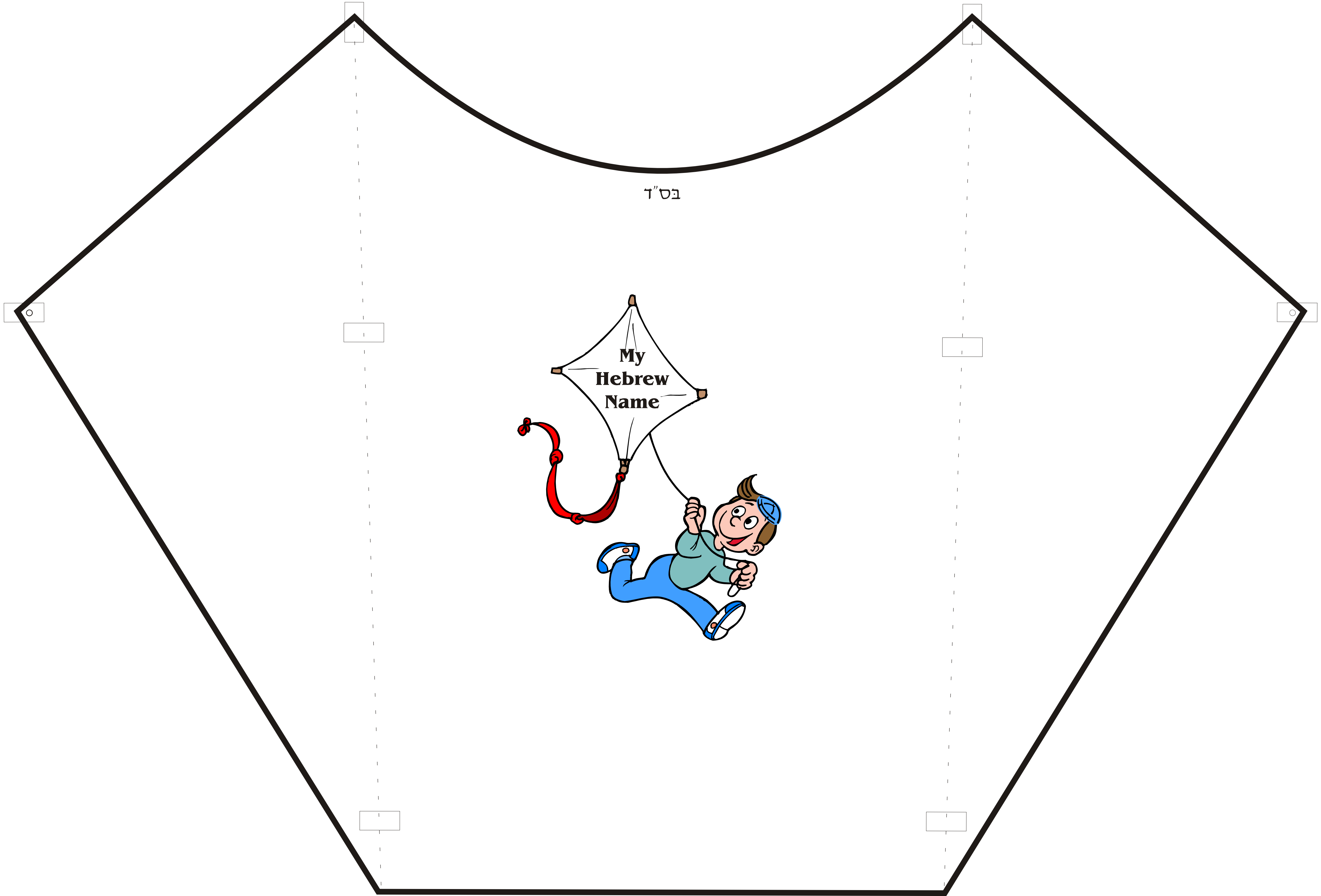
You are ready to **GO FLY A YIDDISH-KITE!**

MAKE YOUR VERY OWN SURE-HIGH-FLY YIDDISH-KITE!

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Follow these 10 simple steps in their number order.





בס"ד

My
Hebrew
Name